

Interpersonal Relationship (IR)

Brainstorming Question

1. What is Interpersonal Relationship?

Definition

Interpersonal relationship is:

- **A strong bond between two or more people.**
- The attraction of individuals from each other.

[illegible]

Forms of IR

An interpersonal relationship can develop between any of the following:

- Individuals working together in the same organization.
- People working in the same team.
- Relationship between a man and a woman (Love, Marriage).
- Relationship with immediate family members and relatives.
- Relationship of a child with his parents.
- Relationship between friends.

Forms...Cont'd

- Relationship can also develop in a group (Relationship of students with their teacher, relationship of a religious guru with disciples and so on).

[illegible]

Preconditions in an IR

- **Share common goals and objectives.** They should have more or less similar interests and think on the same lines.
- **Respect each other's views and opinions.** A sense of trust is important.
- **Attached to each other** for a healthy interpersonal relationship.
- **Transparency plays** a pivotal role in interpersonal relationship. It is important for an individual to be **honest and transparent.**

[illegible]

Stages in IR

- Interpersonal relationship refers to a strong association between individuals sharing common interests and goals.
- A sense of **trust, loyalty and commitment** is essential in a relationship.
- Individuals need to trust and respect their partners to avoid misunderstandings and conflicts in relationship.
- **Stages in an interpersonal relationship.** It takes time for a relationship to grow and pass the test of time.

[illegible]

Possibilities in a relationship

There are two possibilities in a relationship:

- **Possibility - 1:** Two people might start a relationship as mere strangers. They get to know each other slowly and become emotionally and mentally attached to their partners gradually.
 - ✓ Such relationships often lead to lasting commitments where individuals decide to be with each other until death separates them.
- **Possibility - 2:** Two people might start off well but soon face problems. Troubles in relationship start when people have different opinions, views and fail to reach to a mutually acceptable solution.
 - ✓ In such cases individuals decide to move on from a relationship for a fresh start.

[illegible]

Stages of relationship

According to famous psychologist George Levinger, every **relationship goes through following five stages**.

- 1.First Stage – Acquaintance:** refers to knowing each other. To start relationship individuals need to know each other well.
- **Common friends, social gatherings, same organizations** also help people meet, get acquainted with each other and start a relationship.

Stages...Cont'd

2. Second Stage – The Build up Stage

- The build up stage in a relationship is often characterized by two individuals **coming close, being passionate and feeling for each other.**

3.Third Stage – Continuation Stage

- This is the stage when relationship **blossoms into lasting commitments.** It is when people after knowing each other well decide to be in each other's company and tie the knot.
- Trust and transparency is essential for the charm to stay in relationship forever.

Stages...Cont'd

4. Fourth Stage – Deterioration

- Not all relationships pass through this stage. Lack of compatibility, trust, love and care often lead to misunderstandings and serious troubles in relationship.

Stages...Cont'd

5. Fifth Stage – The Termination Stage

- The fifth and the last stage is the **end of a relationship**.
- Relationship terminates due to any of the following reasons
 - **Death** of any one partner
 - **Divorce**
 - **Separation**

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Types of Interpersonal Relationships

1. Friendship

- Friendship is an unconditional interpersonal relationship where individuals enter into by their own sweet will and choice.
- Friendship is a relationship where there are no formalities and individuals enjoy each other's presence.
- Friendship can be between:
 - Man and a woman
 - Man and man
 - Woman and woman

Friendship...Cont'd

- Feelings like ego, jealousy, hatred, anger do not exist in friendship.
- The entire relationship of friendship revolves around trust and give and take.
- No relationship can be one sided and same with friendship. Try to do as much as you can for your friends.

[illegible]

2. Love

- An IR characterized by passion, intimacy, trust and respect is called love.
- Individuals in a romantic relationship are deeply attached to each other and share a special bond.

Must have in a Romantic relationship:

- Two partners must trust each other.
- A sense of respect and mutual admiration.
- Partners must reciprocate each other's feelings for the charm to stay in the relationship for a longer period of time.

[illegible]

3. Platonic Relationship

- A relationship between two individuals without any feelings or sexual desire for each other is called a platonic relationship.
- In such a relationship, a man and a woman are just friends and do not mix love with friendship.
- Platonic relationships might end in romantic relationship with both the partners developing mutual love and falling for each other.

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4. Family Relationship

- Individuals **related by blood or marriage** are said to form a family.
- **Nuclear family** (core family members: Father, Mother and Children).
- **Extended Family** (Core family members plus grand mother and grand father, aunt, uncle and other relatives)

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5. Professional Relationship (Work Relationship)

- Individuals working together for the same organization are said to share a professional relationship.
- Individuals sharing a professional relationship are called colleagues.
- Colleagues may or may not like each other.

[illegible]

Factors affecting IR

1. Compatibility

- Two individuals in a relationship must be compatible with each other. There should be **no scope of conflicts and misunderstandings** in a relationship.
- Individuals from similar backgrounds and similar goals in life do extremely well in relationships.
- **People with different aims, attitudes, thought processes find it difficult to adjust** and hence fail to carry the relationship to the next level.

Factors affecting...Cont'd

2. Communication

- Communication plays a pivotal role in all types of relationships whether it is personal or professional. Individuals need to communicate with each other effectively for better understanding.
- In professional relationships as well, colleagues must communicate well for a better bonding.
- The recipient must understand what the sender intends to communicate and vice a versa.

Factors affecting...Cont'd

3. Honesty

- Be honest in relationships. Do not lie or hide things from your partner. Remember every problem has a solution.
- Think before you speak.
- Transparency is important in relationships.

4. Stay calm

- Do not overreact on petty things in relationships. Stay calm. Be a little more adjusting.
- Be the first one to say “Sorry”. It will solve half of your problems.

Factors affecting...Cont'd

5. Forgiving

- An individual needs to be a little more forgiving in relationships.
- Do not drag issues unnecessarily.
- Fighting over small issues is foolish and makes the situation all the more worse.

Factors affecting...Cont'd

6. Smile

- As they say “Smile is a curve that makes everything straight.” Flash your smile more often. It works. Take care of your facial expressions while interacting with the other person.

7. Time

- Time plays an important role in relationships. **Individuals in love must spend adequate time to know each other better.**
- Frustrations arise when people do not have time to meet or interact with each other. Even in organization, individuals must spend quality time with their co workers to strengthen the bond amongst themselves.

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Role of Communication in IR

- **Communication is said to be the basis of every interpersonal relationship.** In fact effective communication is the key to a healthy and long lasting relationship.
- **Communication plays a pivotal role in reducing misunderstandings** and eventually strengthens the bond among individuals.
- **A relationship loses its charm if individuals do not express and reciprocate their feelings through various modes of communication.**

Role of Communication...Cont'd

- **Take care of your tone and pitch.**
- **Choice of words is important in relationships.**
- **Individuals can also communicate through emails.**
- **Be polite.**
- **Try to understand the other person's point of view as well. Be a patient listener.** Unless you listen carefully, you will never be able to communicate effectively.
- **An individual must interact with the other person regularly for the relationship to grow and reach to the next level. Speaking over the phone.**

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Improve IR

How to Improve IR at Workplace ?

- **Employees must communicate with each other effectively** for a healthy relationship. Remember a problem shared is a problem halved.
- **Interact with your co-workers more often.**
- Even employees from a different team can be your friends.
- **Team leaders and supervisors should conduct morning meetings** with their team members.

Improve...Cont'd

- **Take your team out for lunch, picnics or get together once in a while.**
- **Greet your colleagues on their birthdays or anniversaries.**
- Individuals should be motivated to work in teams.
- One needs to be a little more adjusting and compromising at the workplace.
- Stand by your colleagues when needed.
- **Avoid being jealous.**

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Importance of IR at Workplace

Motivating Questions:

- **Why interpersonal relationship at workplace?**
- **Why do employees need to be cordial to each other ?**

Importance of IR ...Cont'd

- An individual spends around eight to nine hours in his/her organization and it is practically not possible for him/her to work all alone.**
- A single brain alone can't take all decisions alone.**
- Interpersonal relationship has a direct effect on the organization culture.**

Importance of IR ...Cont'd

- **We need people around who can appreciate our hard work and motivate us from time to time.**
- **It always pays to have individuals around who really care for us.**
- **An individual needs to get along with fellow workers to complete assignments within the stipulated time frame.**
- **An Individual working all alone is **overburdened** and **never finishes tasks within deadlines.****

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Tips to Improve IR at Workplace

- Do not treat **office as your home**.
- An individual should **not interfere** in his colleague's work.
- Give space to your **fellow workers**.
- Do not spread baseless rumors at workplace.
- Pass on correct information to others.
- Do not share all your secrets with your co workers.
- Leave your ego behind.
- A team leader should not scold any of his team members in front of others.
- **Stay away from nasty politics at workplace**.

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